

Application for Cyber Security Engineer Graduate Scheme

Dear Lloyds Banking Group Recruitment Team,

I am applying for the Cyber Security Engineer Graduate Scheme in Edinburgh. Building security into systems rather than adding it afterwards is the direction I want my career to take, and the emphasis on secure design, detection capability and automation in the Chief Security Office is the work I am aiming for.

My strongest asset for this role is Python. I use it for scripting and automation, and I have built two working tools with it. The first is a phishing analysis prototype that highlights suspicious email indicators and maps findings to MITRE ATT&CK techniques, keeping sensitive email data local. The second maps Windows error codes to their common causes, and I used it to trace intermittent server freezes to missing or corrupted DLLs. I also built a Chrome extension in JavaScript with 25 detection patterns, tested across 150 manual cases to 93.7% accuracy, which gave me direct experience of shipping something and then reducing its false positives through testing.

My formal background is an MSc in Information Security from Royal Holloway, awarded with Merit, and a BCA in computer applications where my modules included Python, Java, JavaScript, C++, SQL and mobile development. I hold CompTIA Security+ and ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity. In my current IT support role I am the first point of contact for 15 colleagues, monitor server health, maintain access controls and use PowerShell and Python to automate repetitive checks. At Co-op I introduced documentation that cut incident management time by more than half.

I should be straightforward about where I would be starting. My experience is with established infrastructure rather than cloud-native engineering, so the deployment tooling and CI/CD pipelines you mention would be new to me, and my cloud knowledge is at a foundational level rather than production scale. I am drawn to this scheme precisely because it builds those skills in a structured way, with the cloud certifications and the Security Engineering Guild you describe. What I bring is the Python foundation you ask for, a habit of automating manual work, and a record of learning tooling quickly when a problem requires it.

What attracts me to Lloyds is the scale of what the Chief Security Office protects and the framing of security as something that lets the business move faster rather than something that slows it down. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my technical background could contribute to your security engineering teams. Thank you for considering my application.

Kind regards,

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